

YEAR 9 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 3 · PERSONAL LIFE & WELL-BEING

Grammar

B2.1

Simple Past vs Past Progressive · Talking About the Past: could (ability), used to, would · Wh- Questions: How long...? and other question words · Question Tags (Simple Past, Past Progressive, used to) · Prepositions and Prepositional Phrases

Hazırlık
Sonrası 9.
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Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Discover the grammar from examples, explain the rule in your own words and use it correctly in context.

Simple Past vs Past Progressive

1 · NOTICE

- Last month I **caught** a bad cold and **stayed** in bed for three days.
- I **was feeling** really anxious when the phone **rang** with my exam results.
- While Selin **was jogging** in the park, she **twisted** her ankle.
- At 8 p.m. yesterday, I **was doing** a breathing exercise to calm down after a stressful day.

Which actions were short and complete? Which action was already in progress when something else happened? Where do 'while' and 'when' usually go?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

was/were + -ing

verb + -ed / irregular form

in progress at a specific past time

interrupted an action in progress

- For a completed action in the past, we use the Simple Past: _____.
- For an action that was _____ in the past, we use the Past Progressive: _____.
- A short action in the Simple Past often _____ a longer action in the Past Progressive (with 'while' or 'when').

B Build sentences

Use the cues to build true sentences. Choose the Simple Past or the Past Progressive.

e.g. I feel / anxious when the results came out

I was feeling anxious when the results came out.

- last week I / catch a cold

2. while / she jog she twisted her ankle

3. at 9 p.m. yesterday I / do a breathing exercise

4. when the phone rang we / talk about stress management

5. ? / you sleep well last night

C Your turn

Write four sentences about a time you felt unwell or stressed: one completed action, one interrupted action with 'while', and one question in the Simple Past.

Last..., I felt... While I was..., ... When..., I was... Did you ever...?

RULE

The Simple Past describes a completed, often short action in the past (verb + -ed or an irregular form). The Past Progressive (was/were + -ing) describes an action that was in progress at a specific past moment. 'While' usually introduces the Past Progressive, 'when' usually introduces the Simple Past; the two combine when a shorter action interrupts a longer one.

TR Simple Past, geçmişte tamamlanmış, kısa süreli eylemleri anlatır (fiil + -ed ya da düzensiz fiil). Past Progressive (was/were + -ing) ise geçmişte belirli bir anda devam etmekte olan bir eylemi anlatır. 'While' genellikle Past Progressive ile, 'when' ise genellikle Simple Past ile kullanılır; uzun eylem yarıda kesildiğinde bu iki zaman birlikte kullanılır.

When?

We use these tenses to describe a past illness, accident or stressful moment, and to show that one action was happening when another one occurred.

TR Geçmişte yaşadığımız bir hastalık, kaza ya da stresli bir anı anlatırken; bir eylem devam ederken başka bir şeyin olduğunu belirtirken bu zamanları kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
I caught a cold last week.	He didn't sleep well last night.	Did you recover quickly?	Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
She was feeling stressed all morning.	We weren't exercising much that month.	Was she jogging when it happened?	Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
While I jogged, my phone rang.	While I was jogging, my phone rang.	'While' usually introduces an ongoing action (Past Progressive), not a short completed one. TR 'While' genellikle devam eden bir eylemi (Past Progressive) tanıtır.
I was catching a cold last week.	I caught a cold last week.	A single, completed event needs the Simple Past, not the Past Progressive. TR Anlık, tamamlanmış bir eylem için Simple Past kullanılır.
She was feel stressed yesterday.	She was feeling stressed yesterday.	The Past Progressive always needs -ing on the main verb. TR Past Progressive'de fiile mutlaka -ing eklenir.

1 Choose the correct option.

4 × 1 pts

- I _____ a bad headache after the exam.
☐ a had ☐ b was having ☐ c have
- While she _____ in the park, it started to rain.
☐ a jogged ☐ b was jogging ☐ c jogs
- When the alarm rang, I _____ yoga.
☐ a did ☐ b was doing ☐ c do
- _____ you sleep well last night?
☐ a Did ☐ b Were ☐ c Was

2 Complete with the correct form.

3 × 1 pts

- Last month, Ali _____ (catch) the flu and _____ (miss) a whole week of school.
- At 7 a.m. yesterday, I _____ (do) my morning stretches.
- We _____ (talk) about stress management when the teacher _____ (walk) in.

3 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

- While I was cooking dinner, I burned my hand. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- I was catching a cold last week and stayed home. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

4 Complete with Simple Past or Past Progressive.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

- A: What _____ you _____ (do) when you hurt your back?
- B: I _____ (lift) some boxes at home, and I _____ (feel) a sharp pain suddenly.

5 Reorder the question.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. when what it you were happened doing ?
-

Talking About the Past: could (ability), used to, would

1 · NOTICE

- As a child, I **could** run for hours without getting tired.
- I **used to** eat a lot of junk food, but now I try to eat more vegetables.
- Every summer, my grandmother **would** take a long walk before breakfast.
- We didn't **use to** worry so much about screen time when we were younger.

Which word talks about a past ability? Which two describe repeated past habits? Which one is NOT normally used for past states like 'live' or 'have'?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

a past ability repeated actions only, not states past habits and states that are now different

- 'Could' + base verb describes _____ (a general skill in the past).
- 'Used to' + base verb describes _____, contrasted with the present.
- 'Would' + base verb also describes past habits, but it is used for _____.

B Build sentences

Complete each sentence with *could*, *used to* or *would* (sometimes more than one is possible).

e.g. As a child, I swim / not very well.

As a child, I couldn't swim very well.

- My dad always / go for a run before work (habit)
 - I eat / not vegetables when I was younger (state, now different)
 - She touch her toes without bending her knees (past ability)
 - We live in a small flat before we moved (state)
-

5. ? / you used to / have more free time in Grade 7

C Your turn

Write three sentences comparing your habits or abilities now with the past: one with 'could', one with 'used to', and one with 'would'.

When I was younger, I could...

I used to..., but now...

Every weekend, I would...

RULE

'Could' describes a general past ability (negative: couldn't). 'Used to' + base verb describes past habits AND states (live, have, like) that are no longer true. 'Would' also describes repeated past habits/actions, but it is NOT used with state verbs like live, have or like.

TR 'Could' geçmişteki genel bir yeteneği anlatır (olumsuzu: couldn't). 'Used to' + fiil, geçmişte düzenli olan ama artık geçerli olmayan alışkanlıkları VE durumları (yaşamak, sahip olmak gibi) anlatır. 'Would' da tekrar eden geçmiş alışkanlıkları anlatır, ancak durum bildiren fiillerle (live, have, like) KULLANILMAZ.

When?

We use these forms to describe past abilities, habits and states that have changed, especially when comparing old and new habits related to health and well-being.

TR Geçmişteki yeteneklerimizi, alışkanlıklarımızı ve şimdi farklı olan durumlarımızı anlatırken; sağlık, spor ya da yeme alışkanlıklarındaki değişimi karşılaştırırken bu yapıları kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
I could run fast as a child.	I couldn't sleep well that	Could you swim when you	Yes, I could. / No, I couldn't.
We used to eat out every	week.	were five?	Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
Friday.	I didn't use to like	Did you use to play outside	
My grandmother would	vegetables.	a lot?	
walk every morning.			

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
I would live in İzmir when I was a child.	I used to live in İzmir when I was a child.	'Would' is not used with state verbs like live, have or like; use 'used to' instead. TR 'Would' durum bildiren fiillerle (live, have, like) kullanılmaz; bunun yerine 'used to' kullanılır.
She use to exercise every day.	She used to exercise every day.	In positive sentences, 'used to' always keeps the -d, unlike the question/negative form ('use to'). TR Olumlu cümlede 'used to' her zaman -d ile yazılır.
I could improved my diet last year.	I improved my diet last year. / I was able to improve my diet last year.	For a single successful past achievement (not a general ability), use the Simple Past or 'was/were able to', not 'could'. TR Geçmişte TEK BİR başarılı eylem için 'could' değil, Simple Past ya da 'was/were able to' kullanılır.

6 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- As a child, I _____ swim across the whole pool.
(a) could (b) would (c) used
- We _____ a big garden before we moved to the city.
(a) would have (b) used to have (c) could have
- Every evening, my mum _____ read to us before bed.
(a) used (b) would (c) could

7 Complete with the correct form.

2 × 1 pts

- I _____ (not/use to) exercise regularly, but now I go to the gym three times a week.
- _____ you _____ (use to) live near the sea?

8 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

- She would like sport a lot when she was younger. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- When I was ten, I could stay up late and still wake up early with lots of energy. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

9 Complete with could, used to or would.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

- When I was in primary school, I _____ (have) lots of energy. Every day after school, I _____ (play) football with my friends for hours, and I _____ (not/get) tired at all.

Wh- Questions: How long...? and other question words

1 · NOTICE

- **How long** have you had that cough?
- **Why** did you feel so anxious before the presentation?
- **How often** do you check your phone during the day?
- **What** helped you recover from the stress of exam season?

What information does each question word ask for — duration, reason, frequency or a thing/action?

What comes right after the question word?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

duration (length of time)

reason

frequency

auxiliary + subject + base verb

1. 'How long' asks about _____.
2. 'Why' asks about the _____ for something.
3. 'How often' asks about _____.
4. After the wh- word, a question usually follows this word order: _____.

B Build sentences

Write the full wh- question for each answer.

e.g. Answer: I've had this headache for two days.

How long have you had this headache?

1. Answer: I felt stressed because I had three tests in one day.

2. Answer: I check my phone about ten times a day.

3. Answer: Talking to my best friend helped me feel better.

4. Answer: I usually go to bed around eleven.

C Your turn

Write four *wh-* questions you could ask a classmate about their well-being (sleep, stress, exercise, screen time), using at least two different question words.

How long...?

How often...?

Why...?

What...?

RULE

Wh- question words (what, why, how long, how often, etc.) ask for specific information and normally come first in the question, followed by auxiliary + subject + base verb. 'How long' asks about duration, 'how often' about frequency, and 'why' about reason.

TR *Wh-* soru kelimeleri (what, why, how long, how often, what helped vb.) belirli bir bilgi istemek için kullanılır ve genellikle cümle başına gelir; ardından yardımcı fiil + özne + yalın fiil sırası izlenir. 'How long' süre, 'how often' sıklık, 'why' sebep sorar.

When?

We use *wh-* questions to get detailed information about health, feelings and habits — for example, to ask how long a symptom has lasted or why someone feels stressed.

TR Sağlık, duygular ve alışkanlıklar hakkında ayrıntılı bilgi almak istediğimizde *wh-* sorularını kullanırız — örneğin bir semptomun ne kadar sürdüğünü ya da neden stresli hissettiğimizi sormak için.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
How long have you had this symptom? Why do you feel anxious today?	Why didn't you sleep well last night?	How often do you exercise? What helps you relax?	For about a week. / Since Monday. Because I had a big test.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
How long you have had this cough?	How long have you had this cough?	In a <i>wh-</i> question, the auxiliary comes before the subject, not after. TR <i>Wh-</i> sorularda yardımcı fiil öznenin ÖNCE gelir.
How often you check your phone?	How often do you check your phone?	Don't forget the auxiliary <i>do/does</i> in a Simple Present question. TR Simple Present'ta yardımcı fiil (<i>do/does</i>) unutulmamalı.

10 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- _____ have you been feeling tired?
 (a) How long (b) How often (c) Why
- _____ do you check social media during the day?
 (a) Why (b) How often (c) How long
- _____ did you feel so relieved after the exam?
 (a) Why (b) How long (c) How often

11 Complete with the correct wh- word.

2 × 1 pts

- _____ helped you cope with the stress before the exam?
- _____ have you had that headache — since this morning or longer?

12 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

- How long you have felt this way? ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- Why did you feel so anxious before the presentation? ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

13 Reorder the question.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

- you how long had cough have that ?

Question Tags (Simple Past, Past Progressive, used to)

1 · NOTICE

- You didn't sleep well last night, **did you?**
- She used to play a lot of sport, **didn't she?**
- You were feeling stressed before the test, **weren't you?**
- We couldn't finish the relaxation exercise in time, **could we?**

When the main sentence is negative, is the tag positive or negative? What auxiliary verb does each tag repeat?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

negative

positive

same auxiliary/modal as the main verb

1. A positive sentence takes a _____ tag.
2. A negative sentence takes a _____ tag.
3. The tag always uses the _____ (did/didn't, was/wasn't, could/couldn't...).

B Build sentences

Add the correct question tag to each sentence.

e.g. You felt exhausted after the trip, ___?

You felt exhausted after the trip, didn't you?

1. She wasn't sleeping well last month, ___?

2. They used to go jogging together, ___?

3. You couldn't relax during exam week, ___?

4. He was feeling anxious before the interview, ___?

C Your turn

Write three true statements about a past habit or feeling, each with a question tag, and ask a partner to confirm them.

You used to..., didn't you?

You were feeling..., weren't you?

You couldn't..., could you?

RULE

Question tags with past tenses follow the same golden rule: a positive sentence takes a negative tag, a negative sentence takes a positive tag, and the tag repeats the same auxiliary or modal as the main sentence (did/didn't, was/wasn't, could/couldn't; 'used to' takes did/didn't).

TR Geçmiş zamanlarla kullanılan question tag'ler de aynı altın kurala uyar: olumlu cümleye olumsuz, olumsuz cümleye olumlu bir tag eklenir; tag ana cümledeki yardımcı fiil/modal ile aynı olur (did/didn't, was/wasn't, could/couldn't, used to → didn't).

When?

We use these tags to check or confirm information about a past situation or habit, especially when talking about health and feelings.

TR Geçmişte yaşanan bir durumu ya da alışkanlığı teyit etmek istediğimizde, özellikle sağlık ve duygu durumu hakkında sohbet ederken bu tag'leri kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
You slept badly last night, didn't you?	She wasn't feeling well, was she?	They used to exercise together, didn't they?	Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?	
You used to smoke, usedn't you?	You used to smoke, didn't you?	Tags for 'used to' sentences always use did/didn't, never 'usedn't'. TR 'used to' cümlelerinde tag her zaman did/didn't ile yapılır.	
You couldn't sleep, could you not?	You couldn't sleep, could you?	Negative tags use the contracted form (couldn't, wasn't); 'could you not' is not a natural tag. TR Olumsuz tag'lerde kısaltma kullanılır ('couldn't', 'wasn't' gibi); 'could you not' doğal değildir.	

14 Choose the correct tag.

2 × 1 pts

- You felt better after the walk, _____?
 (a) didn't you (b) did you (c) weren't you
- She wasn't coping well with the stress, _____?
 (a) was she (b) wasn't she (c) did she

15 Complete with the correct tag.

2 × 1 pts

- You used to skip breakfast, _____?
- They couldn't finish the relaxation exercise, _____?

16 Judge the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

- You were feeling anxious yesterday, was you? ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

17 Add the tag.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. You used to play a team sport, _____?

Prepositions and Prepositional Phrases

1 · NOTICE

- I've had this cough **for** three days and it started **after** the school trip.
- She's really good **at** dealing **with** stress.
- Talking **about** your feelings can help you cope **with** anxiety.
- He went **to** the doctor's **because of** a persistent headache.

Which prepositions go with time (for, after)? Which prepositions are 'fixed' after certain words (good at, cope with, talk about)? What comes after 'because of'?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

a noun or -ing form

a duration of time

fixed expressions with adjectives/verbs

1. 'For' + a number/period expresses _____.
2. Expressions like 'good at', 'cope with' and 'talk about' are _____ — the preposition doesn't change.
3. 'Because of' is followed by _____, not a full clause.

B Build sentences

Complete each sentence with the correct preposition.

e.g.

She's very good ____ managing her time.

She's very good at managing her time.

1. I've felt tired ____ almost a week now.

2. He missed school ____ a bad cold.

3. Talking ____ a counsellor really helped her.

4. It's important to deal ____ stress in a healthy way.

5. My sleep improved ____ I started switching off my phone earlier.

C Your turn

Write three sentences about well-being using at least three different prepositional phrases from this lesson (for + time, good at, cope with, because of, talk to/about).

I'm good at...

I try to cope with... by...

I felt better because of...

RULE

Prepositions form fixed expressions of time (for + duration, since + starting point), reason (because of + noun/-ing) and with certain verbs/adjectives (good at, cope with, deal with, talk to/about). These patterns need to be learned individually, since they often don't match Turkish word-for-word.

TR Edatlar (preposition) zaman (for + süre, since + başlangıç noktası), sebep (because of + isim/-ing) ve belirli fiil/sıfatlarla sabit kalıplar (good at, cope with, deal with, talk to/about) oluşturur. Bu kalıplar ezberlenmelidir çünkü çoğu zaman Türkçedeki karşılıklarıyla birebir örtüşmez.

When?

We need the correct prepositions when describing how long a health or emotional state has lasted, its cause, or how someone deals with it.

TR Bir sağlık ya da duygu durumunun ne kadar sürdüğünü, sebebini ya da onunla nasıl başa çıkıldığını anlatırken doğru edatları kullanmamız gerekir.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
I've had this cold for three days. She's good at staying calm.	He isn't very good at coping with pressure. We didn't talk about it much.	How long have you had it for? What helps you deal with stress?	Since Monday. / For a week. Exercise and sleep.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
I'm good in managing stress.	I'm good at managing stress.	The adjective 'good' is followed by 'at', not 'in'. TR 'good' sıfatından sonra 'at' kullanılır, 'in' değil.
He missed school because of he was ill.	He missed school because he was ill. / He missed school because of his illness.	'Because of' takes a noun/-ing form; a full clause needs plain 'because'. TR 'Because of' bir isim/-ing alır; tam cümle için 'because' kullanılır.
I've felt tired since three days.	I've felt tired for three days.	Use 'for' with a length of time and 'since' with a specific starting point. TR Süre miktarı için 'for', belirli bir başlangıç noktası için 'since' kullanılır.

18 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- I've had this headache _____ two days.
(a) since (b) for (c) at
- She's really good _____ handling stressful situations.
(a) in (b) at (c) with
- He stayed home _____ a bad stomach ache.
(a) because (b) because of (c) for

19 Complete with the correct preposition.

2 × 1 pts

- It's important to talk _____ your feelings instead of hiding them.
- I've felt more energetic _____ I started sleeping eight hours a night.

20 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

- She copes with pressure really well. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

- I've been feeling low since a few weeks. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

21 Complete with the correct preposition.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

- I've been feeling stressed _____ two weeks now, mostly _____ the amount of homework I have. Talking _____ my parents _____ it really helps me cope _____ the pressure.